

Week 3 Installation Guide: Required Libraries and Tools

Install the tools we will use this week: Python packages (FastAPI stack) + Postman.

1) Confirm you have Python 3

Open **Terminal** and run:

Terminal

```
python3 --version  
pip3 --version
```

If Python is not found on Windows, install it from python.org and **make sure you check**:

☑ “Add python.exe to PATH” during install.

2) Create a project folder (recommended)

Create a folder anywhere, for example `api-class`, then open Terminal/PowerShell inside it.

(Optional but strongly recommended) Create a virtual environment:

Terminal

```
python3 -m venv .venv  
source .venv/bin/activate
```

You should now see `(.venv)` at the start of your Terminal line.

3) Install required Python packages

Run these commands in your activated environment.

Terminal

```
pip3 install fastapi  
pip3 install uvicorn  
pip3 install sqlalchemy  
pip3 install pymysql  
pip3 install cryptography  
pip3 install pydantic python-dotenv
```

Quick install option

If you prefer one command:

Terminal/shell

```
pip install fastapi uvicorn sqlalchemy pymysql cryptography pydantic python-dotenv
```

4) Install Postman

Homebrew

If you already have Homebrew:

Terminal

```
brew install --cask postman
```

If Homebrew is not installed, you can install Postman directly from the website:

- Postman Downloads page: postman.com/downloads

5) Quick test (make sure everything works)

Create a file named `main.py` in your project folder:

python

```
from fastapi import FastAPI

app = FastAPI()

@app.get("/")
def home():
    return {"status": "ok"}
```

Run the server:

Terminal

```
uvicorn main:app --reload
```

Now open in your browser:

- <http://127.0.0.1:8000/>
- <http://127.0.0.1:8000/docs> (Swagger UI)

If `/docs` opens, you are ready for class 